

# Turkey: Equity rout tests lira savings strategy

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## 【メール原文】

Turkey's equity rout has exposed vulnerabilities in financial markets. While the immediate turmoil may be contained, prolonged investor concern could |||||

Quick take

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Turkey's equity rout tests Ankara's lira savings strategy

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Short-term trajectory:

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What Happened

Turkey's BIST 100 fell 5.5% on Wednesday, extending its three-day decline to about 9% after regulators forced an unwinding of positions in response to a warning from index provider MSCI about concentrated fund ownership and low-free-float stocks. The moves have created a liquidity crunch for Pusula Portfoy and devolved into a broader selloff.

Our Take

The episode may complicate Ankara's efforts to keep savings in lira assets. Since Mehmet Simsek's return as finance minister in 2023, Ankara has sought to steer savings away from currency-protected deposits toward conventional lira assets, including funds and equities. The BIST benefited, gaining around 28% in 2026 before the latest selloff.

The subsequent boom in investment funds provided a new vehicle for equity exposure while concentrating risk. Inflows were directed into relatively illiquid stocks linked to the funds themselves, pushing up prices and boosting returns, which in turn attracted further inflows. That cycle now works in reverse: falling prices trigger redemptions, while the difficulty of unwinding illiquid positions forces funds seeking cash to sell more liquid stocks, spreading pressure across the market. In response, larger funds such as Atlas and Tera have since tightened redemption rules, which may help contain the immediate turmoil but have lingering aftereffects.

This is not the first recent speculative cycle to burn retail investors. A previous one occurred in 2022–2023. A sustained loss of confidence in equities could cause household savings to migrate back toward foreign currencies and gold, potentially adding to pressure on the lira and reserves.

A further risk is spillover to non-bank lenders providing consumer credit. Pusula controls Katılımevim, a major savings-financing company focused on homes and vehicles. There is currently no sign of contagion, but the connection provides a potential channel into the real economy. Since receiving

regulatory approval in 2022, these non-bank lenders have expanded rapidly as high rates and credit restrictions pushed borrowers beyond conventional banks: transaction volumes surged 262% over the past year to 1.21 trillion lira (nearly \$25 billion), while the customer base more than doubled to 1.16 million. Contagion or regulation could therefore constrain financing, further weaken already declining housing and auto demand, and dampen overall growth.

The turmoil may increase criticism of Simsek's economic management. Simsek's efforts to raise tax revenue, curb credit growth, and restrain public spending have imposed substantial costs and angered businesses and voters alike. President Recep Tayyip Erdogan, however, has stood firmly behind the program, which has more than halved inflation, rebuilt reserves, and sharply reduced Turkey's sovereign risk despite a challenging global environment. The recent market selloff gives Simsek's critics fresh ammunition. Yet abandoning him now would put the program's gains at risk, with few obvious replacements capable of commanding comparable international credibility. The greater risk is that political pressure eventually constrains Simsek's room for maneuver enough that he chooses to leave.

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